

September 2025

Proposal

Towards a More Peaceful Arakan**Executive Summary**

Growing mistrust among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh threatens to further destabilize the Bangladesh-Myanmar border and undermine efforts to enable peace, security, and development in Arakan State, now almost completely controlled by the Arakan Army. The Stimson Center and hūmānus propose a partnership to implement an 18-month project to identify, create, and support opportunities for trust-building among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh. The project seeks to enhance stakeholders' capacity to engage in dialogue, increase their understanding of one another's interests, and enable external stakeholders to play a more constructive role in alleviating the crisis. To achieve these objectives, Stimson and hūmānus will employ mediation, dialogue, and confidence-building measures, engage key decision-makers, and address gaps in information and analysis.

Context

Since November 2023, the Arakan Army (AA) has made unprecedented military gains in Arakan State. The AA now controls more territory and a larger population than any other non-state armed actor in Myanmar. Moreover, the AA's control of northern Arakan and the totality of the Bangladesh-Myanmar border give it an outsize role in influencing the future of Rohingya remaining in Arakan as well as more than one million Rohingya refugees in Bangladesh.

Though its military victories have been swift, the AA faces tremendous challenges in consolidating control. Arakan hosts nearly 600,000 IDPs. The Myanmar military conducts regular airstrikes on AA-held territory and has imposed an information blackout and a humanitarian blockade on Arakan for much of the past three years, deepening an already dire humanitarian crisis. The AA must create governance structures and service delivery mechanisms from scratch while attempting to rebuild an economy that was one of Myanmar's poorest even before it was battered by years of war and a blockade. Rohingya worry that the AA will treat them little better than the Myanmar military; over 100,000 Rohingya have fled to Bangladesh since the beginning of last year. Across the border in Cox's Bazar, Rohingya face growing insecurity, declining levels of humanitarian support, and little space to exercise agency. AA relations with neighboring Bangladesh are tense: Bangladesh views AA abuses against

Rohingyas as an impediment to repatriation while the AA suspects that Bangladeshi security agencies are supporting a Rohingya insurgency against them. Mistrust between Rohingya and the AA – and, more broadly, Arakanese Buddhists – has soared, exacerbated by the Myanmar military’s efforts to make Arakan ungovernable by sowing communal unrest.

Despite the bleak outlook, the on-going crisis presents numerous opportunities. Though it will continue to employ divide-and-rule tactics, the near complete removal of the Myanmar military from Arakan opens the door to less abusive forms of administration. While the AA has committed abuses against the Rohingya – particularly through its capture of Buthidaung – and there is a wide gap between its actions and its rhetoric, the AA has expressed a desire to create more inclusive governing structures. And Bangladesh’s Interim Government has broken the long-standing taboo against engaging non-state armed groups by talking to the AA, setting the table for further dialogue and possible policy shifts under the next elected government.

Goals, Objectives, and Activities

This project seeks to seize on opportunities to prevent a further deterioration along the Bangladesh-Myanmar border and to bend the arc of Arakan’s trajectory towards a more peaceful future. ***The main goal of this project is to identify, create, and support opportunities for trust-building among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh.*** This trust-building will lay the foundation for: greater prospects for peaceful coexistence; a more prosperous future Arakan State that protects Rohingyas’ rights; increased stability along the Bangladesh-Myanmar border; more durable relations between Bangladesh and the AA; greater space for civil society engagement; and, ultimately (though beyond the scope of the project period), the safe, sustainable, and voluntary repatriation of Rohingya refugees to Myanmar. To the best of the project team’s knowledge, there are no other credible and independent efforts that seek to holistically address mistrust among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh.

To achieve the goal of trust-building among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh, this project will pursue several interrelated objectives: enhance stakeholders’ capacity to engage in dialogue; increase stakeholders’ understanding of one another’s interests; and enable external stakeholders to play a more constructive role at the Bangladesh-Myanmar border.

OBJECTIVE 1: ENHANCE STAKEHOLDERS’ CAPACITY TO ENGAGE IN DIALOGUE

Few stakeholders among the Rohingya, Arakanese, or Bangladesh have experience participating in formal or informal dialogue processes with their counterparts. The

Rohingya in particular are at a structural disadvantage: the community is divided; historic persecution and restrictions in both Arakan and Bangladesh have inhibited the emergence of Rohingya civil society and communication more broadly; significant power disparities are at play; and Rohingya often lack both the support and opportunities to speak for themselves and represent their own interests. Though facing less acute barriers than Rohingya, Arakanese too have faced a history of exclusion and underrepresentation in dialogue processes. Meanwhile, Bangladesh's approach to the crisis has been characterized by a discomfort with engaging non-state actors, including the Arakan Army, and a sidelining of Rohingya from both political and non-political processes. Absent capacity-building support to all stakeholders, efforts to pursue dialogue and engagement could prove counterproductive. Thus, this project seeks to enhance the capacity of Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh to participate in dialogue.

Activity 1.1: Facilitate Trainings and Workshops for Rohingya Civil Society Leaders

In support of mediation and dialogue efforts (see below), the project will provide capacity building to key stakeholders to support and enable their participation in dialogue. Recognizing the challenges Rohingya face to engage – systemic persecution, a fractured civil society, safety concerns – the project will focus in particular on supporting and empowering legitimate and representative Rohingya civil society leaders, including women and youth, from within Bangladesh and Myanmar. Trainings and workshops for Rohingya civil society leaders will be held on a monthly basis and will cover topics such as stakeholder and power mapping exercises, designing strategies for dialogue, and core dialogue skills. Most trainings and workshops will be held virtually so as to enable the participation of Rohingya based in Arakan.

Output: 18 trainings and workshops for Rohingya civil society leaders in Bangladesh and Arakan; 50 virtual sessions with female members of Rohingya civil society; six gender sensitivity training sessions will be held with Rohingya male dialogue participants.

Activity 1.2: Facilitate Trainings and Workshops for Arakanese and Bangladeshi Leaders

To complement support to Rohingya civil society leaders, the project partners will also work bilaterally with Arakanese and Bangladeshi stakeholders to support their ability to engage in dialogue and trust-building initiatives. Among the Arakanese, targets for these trainings and workshops will be Arakanese civil society and humanitarian organizations, media outlets, and members of nascent governing structures. Among Bangladesh, the target audience is think tanks, universities, and working level officials in key line ministries. Because these stakeholders – especially Bangladeshi actors – have a higher base level of knowledge, trainings and workshops for them will be conducted on a more ad hoc basis than for Rohingya.

Output: At least six trainings and workshops for Arakanese and Bangladeshi leaders.

OBJECTIVE 2: INCREASE STAKEHOLDERS' UNDERSTANDING OF ONE ANOTHER'S INTERESTS

In both Arakan and Bangladesh physical and social barriers serve to limit interactions among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladeshis. Rohingya and Arakanese villages in northern Rakhine are often segregated, while barbed wire fencing around the refugee camps in Bangladesh limits engagement between Rohingya and Bangladeshis. Social pressure to limit engagement, combined with communication restrictions and the spread of dis- and misinformation, complicates the situation further. In concert, these factors contribute to a poor understanding among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh and inhibit trust-building among them. This project therefore seeks to increase mutual understanding among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh.

Activity 2.1: Engage with Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh Bilaterally

The project teams will meet with key Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh stakeholders on an on-going basis. The purpose of this engagement is to serve as a channel for information among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh and to share emerging and on-going issues of interest and concern as well as to enhance each parties' contextual understanding from the perspective of other stakeholders. This sharing of information will help to lay the foundation for more formal dialogue processes and confidence-building measures.

Output: Separate meetings with Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh stakeholders on at least a monthly basis.

Activity 2.2: Facilitate Dialogue among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh

The core focus of this project is to build trust among Arakanese, Rohingya, and the Bangladesh authorities. The project will implement a range of activities to support trust-building efforts – including direct dialogue, capacity-building support, and the implementation of confidence-building measures – with specific activities tailored to the context and to the needs and interests of the parties to the conflict.

Where possible, the project will facilitate direct mediation and dialogue between the Arakanese, Rohingya, and the Bangladesh authorities. Should conditions permit, this will entail direct engagement between the AA and Rohingya, the AA and Bangladesh, and Bangladesh and the Rohingya. To this end, the project partners previously facilitated direct dialogue between Rohingya civil society leaders and the AA's political wing, the United League of Arakan (ULA), and have served as a backchannel for the passing of messages between the AA and the Bangladesh Government.

In addition to direct mediation and dialogue at a Track 1.5 level, the project will also implement Track 2 dialogues between Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladeshi civil society actors. The foundations for some of these dialogues are already in place, including between Arakanese and Rohingya women, Arakanese and Rohingya civil society leaders, and Arakanese and Bangladeshi civil society leaders. In addition, ahead of elections expected in Bangladesh in February 2026, the project team has begun to deepen its engagement with Bangladeshi political parties and explore opportunities for engagement between Arakanese, Rohingya, and those likely to play key roles in the next elected government.

Output: Building upon existing dialogues, establish at least four tracks of regular dialogue among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh that meet at least every other month; facilitate at least 12 dialogue meetings between women civil society leaders from Rohingya and Arakanese communities; and facilitate at least four meetings between women Rohingya civil society leaders and Bangladesh authorities.

Activity 2.3: Support the Design and Implementation of Confidence-Building Measures

The project will support the design and implementation of confidence-building measures that reinforce trust-building. Confidence-building measures could take a range of forms, depending on the context, the trajectory of mediation and dialogue efforts, and other project elements. Potential confidence-building measures could include: supporting and facilitating cross-border humanitarian aid; convening stakeholders for in-person dialogue; developing transparent and inclusive governing mechanisms in Arakan; border management mechanisms between Bangladesh and the AA; truth telling and transitional justice among the Arakanese and Rohingya; and establishing crisis communication mechanisms. Rather than taking a prescriptive approach, the project team will take cues from dialogue processes and bilateral engagements with Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh stakeholders to tailor the design and implementation of confidence-building measures to the interests of the parties involved.

Output: At least four confidence-building measures among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh designed and/or implemented; at least one confidence-building measure will either include Arakanese and Rohingya women or result from the women's dialogue between them.

OBJECTIVE 3: ENABLE EXTERNAL STAKEHOLDERS TO PLAY A MORE CONSTRUCTIVE ROLE AT THE BANGLADESH-MYANMAR BORDER

To complement an increase in capacity and mutual understanding among Rohingya, Arakanese, and Bangladesh, this project also seeks to inform and influence external policy and program approaches on the Arakan crisis, including those undertaken by

foreign governments, the United Nations, and humanitarian and development agencies. The project seeks to shape the approaches taken by external stakeholders for two mutually reinforcing reasons: first, through their resources and relationships, external actors possessed significant potential to offer political, rhetorical, and other forms of support to the direct implementation of this project; second, external actors possess critical capacity to support the realization of this project's goal and objectives at a scale not possible through this project alone. As described in the activities below, the project will achieve this objective by providing external stakeholders with regular, nuanced analysis of the situation on the Bangladesh-Myanmar border, through public and private events, and on-going engagement on a bilateral and multilateral basis.

Activity 3.1: Engage Key Decision-Makers

Beyond This project will engage key decision-makers – such as Bangladeshi ministers, bureaucrats, and senior security officials; the UN Resident Coordinator as well as UN and humanitarian agencies; and diplomats in Dhaka, Yangon, and capitals – to support trust-building among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh, to increase international focus on Myanmar and the Arakan crisis, and to address challenges and respond to opportunities as they arise. In particular, the project team will seek to leverage its deep relationships to influence key donors and policymakers, the UN and humanitarian agencies, and civil society actors. Given that Bangladesh exerts significant influence over the Bangladesh-Myanmar border and policy approaches towards the Rohingya and the AA, the project team will engage Bangladesh officials to support trust-building between Arakanese and Rohingya as well as the implementation of confidence-building measures. All engagements related to the Rohingya will seek to provide Rohingya, including women, with opportunities to represent themselves, particularly Rohingya based in Arakan and Cox's Bazar, as safety and communication challenges permit.

Output: At least monthly meetings with key decision-makers among Bangladeshi officials, diplomats, and humanitarian agencies.

Activity 3.2: Address Gaps in Information and Analysis

Arakan has faced widespread communication restrictions since conflict between the Myanmar military and the AA resumed in November 2023. Combined with movement restrictions, information silos, and the fog of war, mis- and disinformation are rampant and sow further mistrust among key stakeholders and make it extremely difficult for donors, policymakers, and humanitarian actors to make effective decisions about their programming and operations. Leveraging deep networks across Bangladesh and Myanmar, this project will seek to address gaps in information related to the on-the-ground situation in Arakan and Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh perspectives of one another through both primary research and monitoring of secondary sources. This research and analysis will serve as the foundation for internal

project design and implementation; will inform mediation, dialogue, and diplomacy efforts; and further aims to empower decisionmakers with nuanced and informed analysis and policy recommendations. As a part of this effort, the project team will provide regular contextual and programmatic briefings to Swiss officials and, where possible, invite donors to join dialogue sessions as observers and to join bilateral meetings with key stakeholders.

Outputs: Regular (weekly/monthly) contextual analysis shared privately; private virtual briefings to Swiss officials (in Yangon, Dhaka, and elsewhere) on an ad hoc basis; quarterly briefing notes/memos; at least four public, virtual events; further informal sharing of information and analysis with key stakeholders via email, messaging apps, and other modalities.

ADDRESSING GENDER DYNAMICS AT THE BANGLADESH-MYANMAR BORDER

Rohingya women in Bangladesh face a complex web of gender-based, cultural, and structural barriers that severely limit their participation in public life. They are usually confined to domestic roles and subject to deeply patriarchal norms that restrict their mobility, education, and decision-making power. For example, in the August 2025 elections in the camp, women were included as just one category out of twelve possible voting identities, making up approximately five percent of the vote. The result is emblematic of a chronic underrepresentation of Rohingya women in decision-making processes that affect their lives, including peacebuilding, education, and humanitarian planning. Arakanese women face equally challenging circumstances living under the effects of the conflict with food shortages, lack of access to humanitarian services, airstrikes and armed groups, limitations on their movement, and exclusion from decision-making processes.

Yet, despite these challenges, some women have demonstrated remarkable leadership, resilience, and a desire to contribute to their community's future – if given the opportunity and support to do so. Stimson Center and hūmānus have been working with these leaders for the last two years. This has been partly supported by the Swiss Embassy in Dhaka, which funded an 18-month project on women's inclusion in dialogue processes project due to end in March 2026. The present project will build on the successes from this work and aims to deepen intercommunal trust and expand the leadership role of Rohingya and Arakanese women in dialogue processes. Since May 2025, a series of online meetings between Rohingya and Arakanese women has laid the groundwork for mutual understanding across historical divides. These informal, women-led spaces have created a safe environment for sharing personal stories, identifying shared concerns, and recognising common goals. Participants have noted a visible shift in perception, with reduced feelings of isolation and growing interest in continued engagement.

To build on this momentum and per above, gender will be integrated into the aforementioned activities as follows:

- Activity 1.1 Facilitate training and workshops for Rohingya civil society leaders
 - 50 virtual dialogue training sessions will be held with female members of Rohingya civil society
 - Six gender sensitivity training sessions will be held with Rohingya male dialogue participants
- Activity 2.2: Facilitate Dialogue among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh
 - 12 dialogue meetings will be facilitated between female civil society leaders from Rohingya and Arakanese communities
 - Four meetings will be facilitated between female Rohingya civil society leaders and Bangladesh authorities
- Activity 2.3: Support the Design and Implementation of Confidence-Building Measures
 - Women will be included in at least one of the four intended confidence-building measures

Illustrative Timetable for Project Implementation

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Cross-cutting: Travel to the region		X			X			X			X			X			X	
1.1/1.2: Trainings for dialogue	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
2.1: Stakeholder Engagement	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
2.2: Hold Dialogue	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
2.3: Design and Implement CBMs	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
3.1: Engage Key Decision-Makers	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
3.2: Weekly analysis	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
3.2: Trip and/or strategic reports			X			X			X			X			X			X
3.2: Public/private roundtables and events			X			X			X			X			X			X
Cross-cutting: Strategic reviews						X						X						

Monitoring and Evaluation

As stated above, the overarching goal of this project is to increase trust among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh. The project also seeks to inform and influence the policy and program approaches of various stakeholders on the Arakan crisis as well as on Myanmar more broadly. In addition to these objectives, this project aims to achieve several other outcomes, including: increasing the capacity of Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladeshi stakeholders to engage in dialogue; increasing collaboration between Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh to address issues of mutual interest and concern; and improve understanding among regional and international actors of dynamics in Arakan and in Myanmar more broadly.

There are several layers to determining if this project successfully increases trust among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh and achieves its other objectives. The first determinant of success is the impact the project has on dialogue participants' feelings of trust towards their dialogue counterparts and to their counterparts' ethnic group as a whole; this will be evaluated by assessing these perceptions at the beginning and end of the project. Data will also be collected on participants' confidence levels to engage in dialogue to assess the value of the trainings and workshops provided.

Another proxy for measuring the success of the project is an increase in the number of individuals participating in dialogue processes, which would demonstrate an increase in trust in both the process and one another.

Beyond the participants themselves, success of the project will be measured by the number of confidence-building measures that are implemented. For example, if a pilot delivery of humanitarian aid is successfully sent from Bangladesh to Myanmar, the beneficiaries of the assistance will be surveyed to determine if the manner in which aid is delivered changed their level of trust in Arakanese or Rohingya. Furthermore, the manner in which cross-border aid is delivered would also allow a qualitative assessment of the support provided by external actors to enable trust-building. If the Government of Bangladesh provides logistical support for cross-border aid, for example, that would demonstrate their support for trust-building between Arakanese and Rohingya and thus, mark a shift in their position on both humanitarian aid and communal dynamics. Similarly, financial support by foreign donors for confidence-building measures such as cross-border aid would signal a change in donors' policies and their backing of trust-building processes. If confidence-building measures implemented by the project are replicated or scaled, that would be another indicator of success.

Though it is beyond the scope of this project to attribute changes in levels of trust among the Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh as a whole to project activities (because trust levels will be based on a range of factors, many of which are out of the control of this project), the project will seek to measure changes in perceptions among Arakanese, Rohingya, and Bangladesh such as through monitoring the public statements of Arakanese and Rohingya leaders and media reporting on communal relations. The extent of public consultations discussing the dialogue component of the project will depend in part on the level of trust established among the participants, which will determine how widely details of the talks are disseminated publicly; if details of the talks are able to be shared publicly (or if they are leaked), the project team will endeavor to conduct consultations with Rohingya, Arakanese, and experts to capture feedback on the process. Where possible, the project will seek to determine how its activities have contributed to changes in levels of trust at the community level through outcome harvesting. A similar approach will be taken to assess the project's impact on relevant policies and programs designed and implemented by the Governments of Bangladesh, donors, and humanitarian agencies.

To complement monitoring and evaluation efforts, the project team will also institute a system of continuous learning. Two strategic reviews – which convene a mix of experts and beneficiaries – will be conducted during the project period to analyze the context, emerging opportunities and challenges, and strengths and weaknesses of the project so as to ensure the project remains both relevant and responsive to a highly fluid operating

environment while also enabling lessons learned and best practice to be incorporated during the project period.

Risks and Risk Mitigation

EXTERNAL RISKS

1. **Mobilization of Rohingya armed actors (*medium-high likelihood*):** The mobilization of Rohingya armed actors since early 2024 by both the Myanmar military and in the refugee camps in Bangladesh has greatly impacted perceptions of trust by Arakanese of Rohingya, creating a perception of threat that is disproportionate to the actual threat and fueling collective punishment. Given the stated intentions of some Bangladesh intelligence agencies and the continued ability of the Myanmar military to exploit communal divisions, this poses a significant risk to the project. These risks will be mitigated by establishing channels of communications between Rohingya and Arakanese, sharing information to dispel misinformation and disinformation, and appealing to the AA by demonstrating the risks of falling prey to the military's divide-and-rule tactics.
2. **Arakanese disengagement (*medium likelihood*):** Close to complete control of Rakhine and with decisive control in northern Rakhine (Rohingya armed groups notwithstanding), the AA and Arakanese more broadly may lose interest in engaging with Rohingya and/or Bangladesh. While this risk may be heightened during forthcoming periods of instability in Bangladesh (see below), it will be mitigated by maintaining relations with a range of stakeholders in the Arakanese community to ensure on-going engagement.
3. **Political instability in Bangladesh (*medium-high likelihood*):** Moderate levels of instability in Bangladesh are likely, particularly in the leadup to and in the immediate aftermath of elections expected in February. Ahead of elections civilian actors may be increasingly unwilling to take controversial decisions while it will likely take time for a new administration to get settled and establish its policy on this issue. Nonetheless, these risks will be mitigated by building and maintaining relationships with a diverse array of stakeholders across the Bangladesh Government, including among diplomatic and security actors, to ensure officials are aware of and at least tacitly support the process.
4. **Spoilers (*medium likelihood*):** Spoilers, whether Rohingya, Arakanese, Bangladeshi, or otherwise, could seek to delegitimize trust-building efforts if awareness becomes public before sufficient trust is built. These risks will be mitigated by ensuring confidentiality and discretion in dialogue processes until sufficient trust is built to withstand external criticism and potential spoilers while also developing plans to manage this concern if/when information about the process enters the public domain.

5. **Communication disruptions (*medium-high likelihood*):** Communication disruptions could make it more difficult to implement in-person activities. This risk will be mitigated by conducting activities (training, dialogue, etc.) virtually in parallel to any in-person activities.
6. **Myanmar military counter-offensive in Rakhine (*low likelihood*):** As it mounts partially successful counter-offensives in Shan, Karenni, and elsewhere, the Myanmar military could soon turn its sights on Rakhine State. Barring major changes to the conflict dynamics, however, this risk is low, particularly in northern Rakhine.

INTERNAL RISKS

1. **Safety of dialogue participants (*medium likelihood*):** Rohingya refugees in particular may be targeted by Rohingya militant groups and/or Bangladeshi intelligence agencies that have expressed opposition to reconciliation with the Arakanese. This risk will be mitigated by ensuring confidentiality and discretion in dialogue processes, while also developing contingency plans if it is not safe for Rohingya participants to remain in the refugee camps in Cox's Bazar (in the past, protection grants have been secured for Rohingya facing imminent security threats). Separately, Arakanese have expressed some security concerns related to traveling to Bangladesh and third countries, risks that will be mitigated by building relationships with Bangladesh Government officials and seeking the support of one or more diplomatic missions to host in-person meetings in Bangladesh.
2. **Access to Bangladesh (*low likelihood*):** Bangladesh could restrict access to Dhaka or Cox's Bazar for members of the project team, impacting face-to-face engagement with Rohingya refugees, Bangladesh authorities, and other key stakeholders. This risk is assessed as low, however, and will be mitigated by maintaining relations with a range of stakeholders in Bangladesh's security services and across the political spectrum.
3. **Financial constraints (*low-medium likelihood*):** A failure to secure additional, complementary funding could impact the implementation of the project. Both hūmānus and The Stimson Center have funding from third sources to contribute to the implementation of the project and are in discussions with other donors with respect to additional funding, though current funds are not sufficient to fully implement this project over 18 months. To mitigate this risk the project team will continue its engagement with other donors, both bilaterally and collectively, to acquire the funds needed.

About The Stimson Center and hūmānus

The Stimson Center promotes international security and shared prosperity through applied research and independent analysis, global engagement, and policy innovation. For more than three decades, Stimson has been a leading voice on urgent global issues. Founded in the twilight years of the Cold War, the Stimson Center pioneered practical new steps toward stability and security in an uncertain world. Today, as changes in power and technology usher in a challenging new era, Stimson is at the forefront: Engaging new voices, generating innovative ideas and analysis, and building solutions to promote international security, prosperity, and justice. The Stimson Center possesses deep expertise and a long track record of work on Myanmar.

hūmānus is an international human rights organisation dedicated to advancing survivor-centred justice for victims of genocide, war crimes, and crimes against humanity. Working across Southeast Asia, the Balkans, and East Africa, it combines strategic litigation, documentation, and advocacy to ensure survivors' voices shape accountability efforts. Recent initiatives include supporting Rohingya survivors in legal proceedings in Argentina and engaging corporate accountability mechanisms linked to mass violence. In partnership with the Arakan Rohingya Society for Peace and Human Rights, hūmānus launched the Rohingya Atrocities Archive, preserving over 3,000 testimonies for legal, advocacy, and historical use.